



beginner

Everyone is a founder

Tyler Lindow · Founder of beginner

Pre-seed · \$500,000

Team



Tyler Lindow

Solo founder. 10 years bridging makers and money — half through software at scale, half through museums.

Problem

Great builders spend whatever time they have left just trying to get a meal in. How can we expect them to be founders if they're still coding, not founding?



tinker

PITCH PROGRESS

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Everyone is a founder.

You just need a seed to start.

Where are you right now?

Cafe

Home

Work

Somewhere else

A guided interview that helps developers figure out their founder pitch. One-hundredth a coach.

Traction

- **May 18, 2026**
App launched. tinker is live.
- **Today, May 28, 2026**
First paid user — the founder.
- **Month 6**
Target: 1,000 paid developers.
- **Month 12**
Target: 2,000 paid developers (~\$216,000 yearly revenue).

Market

\$2.16 billion a year

**20 million developers × \$9 a
month.**

The market is every developer worldwide who could ship a founder pitch. At \$9 a month, this is the ceiling — what we capture is what we earn.

Ask

\$500,000 → 12 months. Closing now — savings run out at the end of May.

\$168,000 — founder salary, 12 months (\$150,000 base + \$18,000 benefits).

\$50,000 — Instagram ads to non-developer makers (target: 2,000 paid users).

\$6,000 — food at monthly community events (\$500/month, 12 months).

\$35,000 — legal, accounting, banking, incorporation.

\$25,000 — Anthropic API (the per-user cost behind the \$9 estimate).

\$20,000 — San Francisco (3 months living + weekly flights home).

\$10,000 — office and dev stack (Industrious \$332/mo + Claude Code \$200/mo + Vercel + PlanetScale + Stytych + GitHub).

\$186,000 — reserves (extends runway to ~18 months at current burn).

Line in the sand: savings run out end of May 2026. If the round doesn't close, I step away.

Thank you

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